

Rewind – "The Dark Room" Design Doc

Core Aesthetic

Dark streaming-service UI. Posters are the color – the app is the dark frame around them. Clean everywhere, cinematic where it counts.

App Structure

Two states: **logged out** and **logged in**. Different experiences.

LOGGED OUT:

`Landing page (sliding gallery + auth modals)`

LOGGED IN:

`Navbar: [ Home ] [ Discover ] [ Watchlist ]`
`Home = Your backlog (randomized display)`
`Discover = TMDB search + trending defaults`
`Watchlist = Completed items from your backlog`

Universal Interaction Rules

Every poster card across the app behaves consistently:

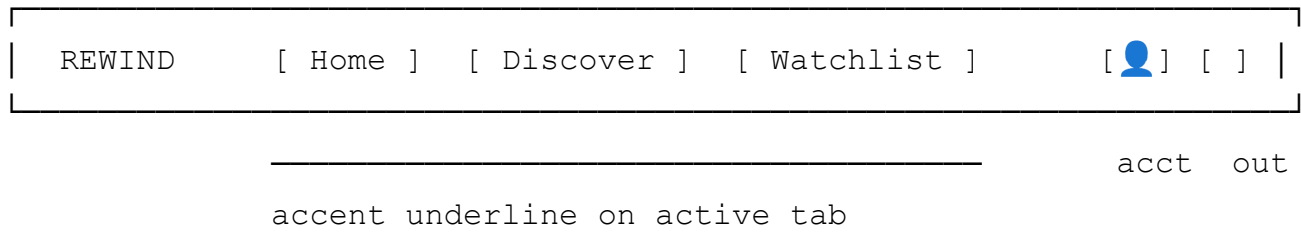
Interaction	Behavior
Click poster	Opens Media Detail page (always, on every page)
Poster hover	Slight brightness lift + shows action buttons

Item states and what you can do with them:

State	Where it appears	Available actions
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State	Where it appears	Available actions
Not saved	Discover results	Add to Backlog
In backlog	Home grid, Discover (with ✓ badge)	Remove, Mark Completed
Completed	Watchlist, Discover (with muted badge)	Move back to Backlog, Remove entirely

Navbar (Logged In)

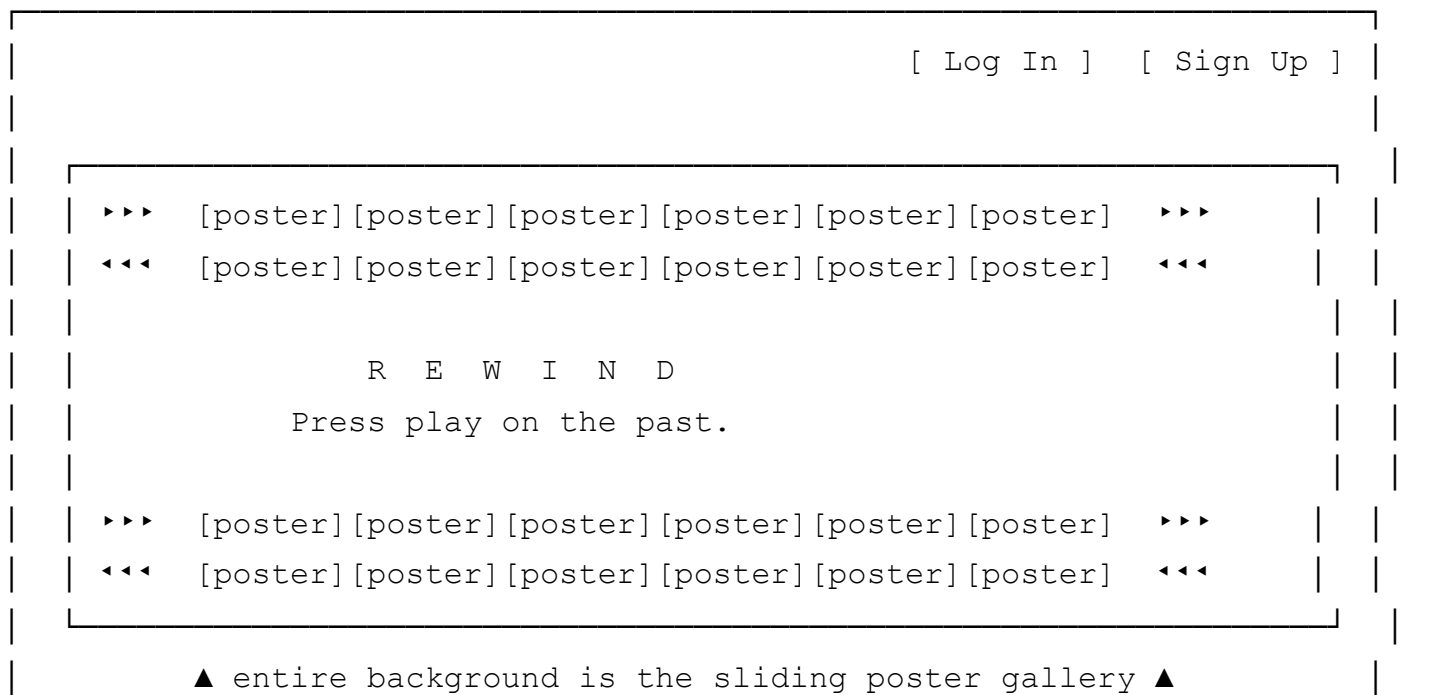


- Left: "REWIND" wordmark (small, tracked-out, links to Home)
- Center: three nav tabs – active tab gets an accent-color underline
- Right: account icon + sign out button, small and unobtrusive
- Dark background (#0a0a0a), sticky top

Landing Page (Logged Out)

The first thing anyone sees. No nav, no feature list – just the brand and a way in.

Layout



Sliding Poster Gallery (Background)

Entire page background is a living wall of trending movie/TV posters.

- **4 rows minimum** – fill the viewport, add more on taller screens
- **Alternating direction:** Row 1 → Row 2 ← Row 3 → Row 4 ←
- **Speed:** Slow, ~30-40s per full cycle. Ambiance, not a slot machine
- **Seamless loop:** Duplicate poster set per row so no gaps when it cycles
- **Dark overlay:** `rgba(0,0,0,0.55-0.7)` between gallery and text
- **Optional blur:** `backdrop-filter: blur(2px)` to soften posters

Data: `GET /tmdb/trending` – fetch ~40 posters, distribute across rows.

CSS: Each row is a flex container with `@keyframes translateX, infinite linear`. Even rows get `animation-direction: reverse`.

Brand Lockup

Centered over the gallery overlay:

- **"REWIND"** – `2.5-3rem`, `letter-spacing: 0.3em`, uppercase, white
- **"Press play on the past."** – `1rem`, `rgba(255,255,255,0.7)`, lowercase

Auth Buttons & Modals

Top-right: **Log In** (ghost button) and **Sign Up** (solid accent button).

Log In [X]

Username

Password

[Log In Button]

Don't have an account? Sign up

- Dark card(#1a1a1a), subtle border, rounded corners
- Gallery keeps scrolling behind the dimmed backdrop
- Bottom link toggles between Log In ↔ Sign Up modals
- Sign Up modal is identical but says "Create Account"

Home (Your Backlog)

This is the main logged-in screen. Title says "My Backlog" but it lives under the Home tab. Every refresh randomizes the display order so it feels fresh – except the Rediscover hero, which always surfaces your oldest-added item.

Layout

REWIND

[Home]

[Discover]

[Watchlist]



[]

FULL-WIDTH BACKDROP IMAGE
(oldest item in backlog)

"The Thing You Forgot About"

Sci-Fi · 2019 · Added 8 months ago

[▶ Completed] [✕ Remove]

gradient fade to bg

REDISCOVER

My Backlog

Sort: ▼

Genre: ▼

poster

poster

poster

poster

poster

	Title	Title	Title	Title	Title	
	Genre	Genre	Genre	Genre	Genre	
	(... more rows, randomized order ...)					
	Empty state: "Your backlog is empty. Head to Discover."					

Rediscover Hero

- Always shows the **oldest item** in your backlog (earliest `date_added`)
- Large backdrop image, big title, genre + how long ago it was added
- Two actions: **Completed** (moves to Watchlist) and **Remove** (deletes from backlog)
- Full-width section with the IMAX gradient treatment

Backlog Grid

- **Default order: randomized on every page load** – shuffled client-side after fetch
- **Sort dropdown:** "Random" (default), "Earliest Added", "Latest Added"
- **Genre filter dropdown:** populated from the genres present in the user's backlog
- Standard poster grid, 5 cols desktop / 2 mobile

Poster Hover (Home Grid)

poster	
[✓ Done] [X]	← appears on hover
Title	
Genre	

- [✓ Done]= marks completed, moves to Watchlist
- [X]= removes from backlog entirely

Backlog Features Summary

Feature	How it works
Add movie/show	From Discover page → "Add to Backlog" toggle
Remove movie/show	Hover [✕] on Home grid, or from Discover toggle, or in detail view
Genre filter	Dropdown filters the grid by genre
Randomized display	Client-side shuffle on load, "Random" sort option
Sort earliest/latest	Sort dropdown changes grid order by <code>date_added</code>
Mark completed	Hover [✓ Done] on Home grid, or Rediscover hero button → moves to Watchlist

Discover (Search + Trending)

REWIND

[Home] [Discover] [Watchlist]

Search movies, shows...

(All) (Action) (Comedy) (Drama) (Sci-Fi) (Horror)

Trending Right Now

(shown when search bar is empty)

poster

Title

2024

poster

Title

2023

poster

Title

2024

poster ✓

(in list)

Title

2022

poster

Title

2024

(... 20-30 items default, more on search ...)

- **Default state (empty search bar):** show top 20-30 trending items from TMDB
- **Search:** queries TMDB by title, replaces trending grid with results

- **Genre chips:** filter results by genre (works for both trending and search)
- **Save toggle:** clicking the badge on an already-saved poster removes it from backlog (acts as an add/remove toggle – no need to navigate away)
- **Status badges on posters:**
 - Not saved → no badge, hover shows [+ Add]
 - In backlog → ✓ checkmark badge, hover shows [✕ Remove]
 - Completed → muted poster + "Watched" badge, hover shows [↶ Back to Backlog] or [✕ Remove]
- Clicking a card (not the badge) opens the **Media Detail Page**

Watchlist (Completed Items)

REWIND	[Home]	[Discover]	[Watchlist]	[]	[]
Watchlist					22 watched
poster	poster	poster	poster	poster	
✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
Title	Title	Title	Title	Title	
Done	Done	Done	Done	Done	
May 12	Apr 3	Mar 20	Feb 8	Jan 15	
Empty: "Nothing here yet. Complete items from your backlog."					

- Poster grid of completed backlog items, sorted by completion date (newest first)
- Each card shows the completion date below the title
- Subtle checkmark overlay or muted poster treatment to visually distinguish from active backlog
- Total count in the top-right corner ("22 watched")
- **Hover actions:** [↶ Back to Backlog] and [✕ Remove] – undo a mistake or delete entirely
- No genre filters – this is a simple reference/trophy screen, not a browsing page
- No cinematic drama – clean and straightforward

Media Detail Page

FULL-WIDTH BACKDROP IMAGE

Title of the Movie

2024 · Action, Sci-Fi · 2h 14m

gradient fade to bg

Description text goes here, light on dark, readable and clean...

States:

- Not saved: [+ Add to Backlog]
- In backlog: [✓ Done] [✕ Remove]
- Completed: [↶ Back to Backlog] [✕ Remove]

- Full IMAX treatment – backdrop + gradient fade
- Button state changes based on whether item is in backlog, completed, or neither

Typography & Color

Token	Value
Font	Inter or DM Sans – one family, weight for hierarchy
Hero titles	2.5–3rem, bold
Section headers	1.5rem, semibold
Body	0.875–1rem, regular
Background	#0a0a0a to #141414
Surface/cards	#1a1a1a to #222222
Primary text	#e5e5e5

Token	Value
Secondary text	#888888
Borders	#2a2a2a
Accent	Pick one: red #e50914 , teal #00b4d8 , amber #f59e0b , or blue #3b82f6

The IMAX gradient: `linear-gradient(transparent → background)` over backdrop images.

Implementation Notes

CSS-only baseline: dark theme, CSS Grid poster layouts, gradient overlays via `::after` , accent color as CSS custom properties, hover transitions with `filter: brightness` .

Optional stretch libraries:

- **Framer Motion** — page transitions, poster entrance animations
- **Swiper.js** — carousel for Rediscover section
- **CSS scroll-snap** — horizontal poster rows (no library needed)